

A GUIDE TO **ASSEMBLING** OUR CABINETS

GENERAL ASSEMBLY GUIDE (2026)

A simplified guide for assembling our bespoke cabinetry

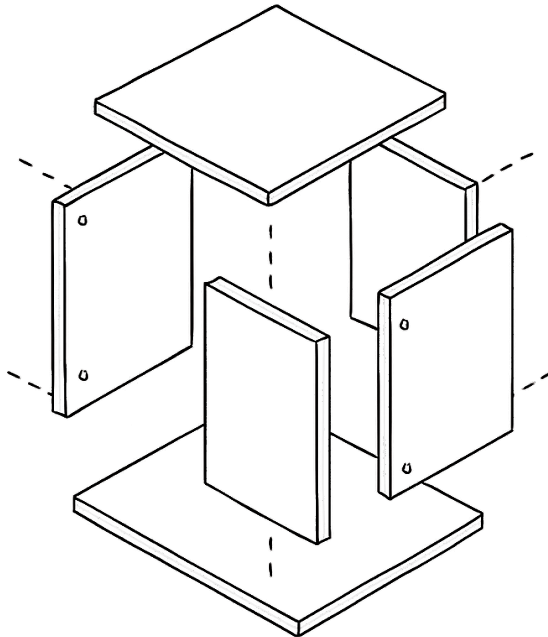


Table of Contents

Contents

Table of Contents	2
General Notes	3
Understand Labels & Plans	4
Essential Parts & Hardware	5
Essential Parts & Hardware	6
Essential Parts & Hardware	7
Hinge Guide (Types & When to Use Them)	8
Adjusting Your Hinges	9
Before You Start Assembly	10
Cabinet with Face Frames	11
Cabinets with Centre Verticals	12
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	13
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	14
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	15
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	16
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	17
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	18
Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)	19
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	20
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	21
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	22
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	23
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	24
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	25
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	26
Drawer Assembly & Fitting	27
Upper Unit & Dresser Tops	28
Upper Unit & Dresser Tops	29
Upper Unit & Dresser Tops	30
Anti-Tilt Brackets	31
Need Help?	32

General Notes

This manual is intended as a general guide for assembling the majority of our cabinet styles. As all of our products are made to order, your cabinet may feature bespoke elements not shown in the examples here. The assembly principles remain the same, and additional guidance is always available — simply contact us if you need help.

General Notes

Our cabinets are designed so that any confident DIYer can put them together. Most customers complete their build without any issues, but if you ever feel stuck, we're always happy to help.

How difficult is my cabinet?

Here's a simple guide to help you judge what to expect:

- **Easy:**
Single cupboards, small wardrobes, standalone boxes
- **Moderate:**
Double cupboards, bookcases, single dressers, or units fitted into alcoves.
(You may need an extra pair of hands.)
- **Advanced:**
Large media units, triple cupboards, multi-cabinet projects, and big dressers.
(Some help from a trades-person may be useful.)

Before starting, take a moment to look through this guide and check the exploded drawings included with your order. Make sure all parts and fittings shown in your plans are present.

If anything looks unclear or you feel unsure at any stage, just reach out — we're here to support you throughout your build.

Important Note:

Since all of our cabinets are bespoke, no two orders are exactly the same.

Before starting your assembly, we strongly recommend reading this guide in full so you understand the key principles and any details specific to your design. Familiarity with the process will save time, prevent errors, and ensure your cabinets come together perfectly.

Understand Labels & Plans

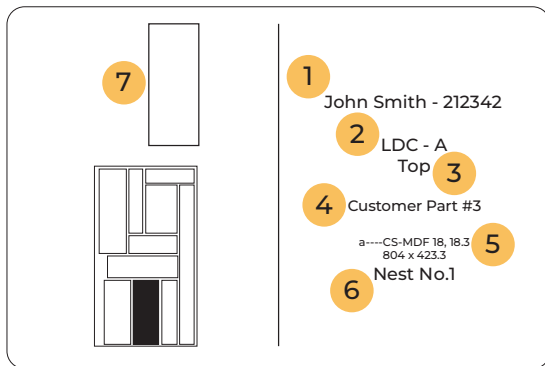
Understanding Your Labels

Every panel in your order will arrive with a label to help you identify where it belongs. Because many parts can look similar, it's always best to check the label against your exploded drawing.

Each label includes the most important information you'll need:

1. **Your Name**
2. **Unit Name**
3. **Panel Description**
4. **Part Number**
5. **Material, Thickness & Dimensions**
6. **Nesting Number (internal use)**
7. **Panel Illustration**

If a label has come off during sanding or handling, don't worry — you can double-check the part by comparing its shape and drilling pattern with your exploded drawings or full plans in your fitting kit.



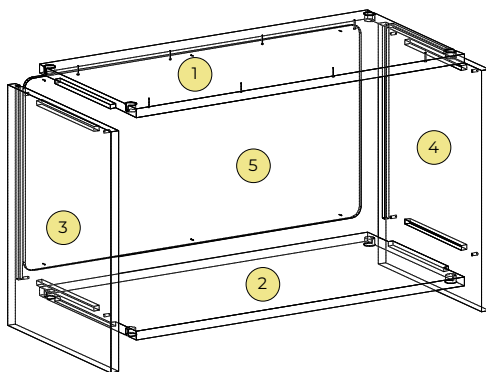
Exploded Drawings

Your fitting kit includes an exploded drawing for each cabinet.

These show:

- every part in the cabinet
- the number assigned to each cabinet
- how the parts fit together

Keep this drawing beside you while building — it's the quickest way to stay on track.



Storing Your Panels Before Assembly

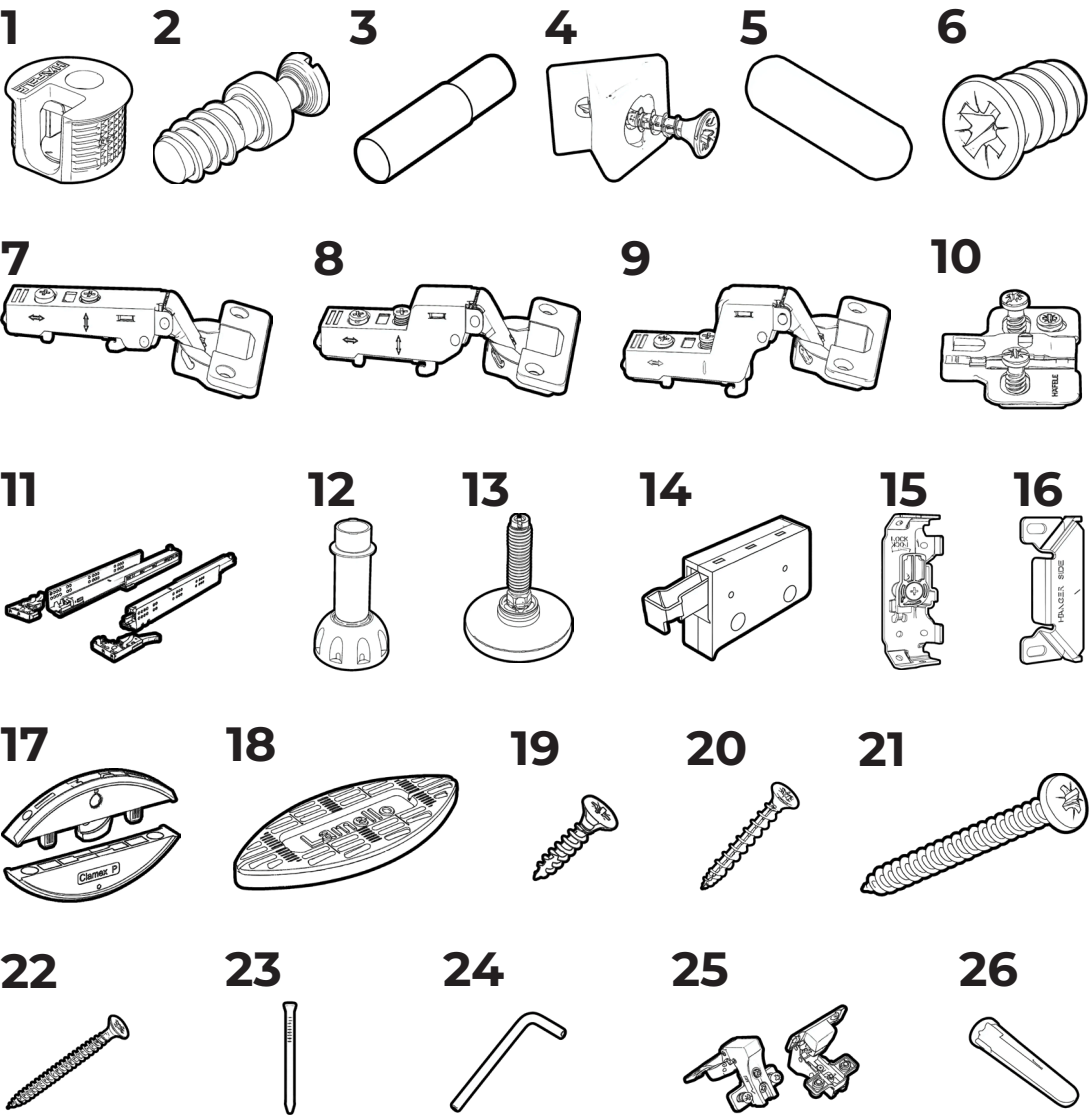
If you're not building your cabinet straight away, make sure to store the panels flat.

Thin panels left leaning or standing for long periods may warp slightly, which can make assembly more difficult.

Essential Parts & Hardware

Essential Parts & Hardware

You'll find all the fittings you need in your fitting kit. Everything is grouped and labelled to match your order. Below is a quick guide to the parts you might find in your fitting kit. Continue to the next page for names and their purpose.



Essential Parts & Hardware

1. Rafix Cam

The most common fitting used for connecting panels together. We'll try to conceal these where possible but if you would like cover caps for any that are exposed, we can supply these for you.

2. Rafix Screw

The counterpart to the Rafix Cam, these bolts are what the Rafix Cam will lock onto.

3. Shelf Pin

Used on all adjustable shelves. These can be tapped in gently for a tighter fit.

4. Rear Panel Connector

These are used for securing a back panel which sits within a panel groove. Can be fastened from behind the back panel to hide them.

5. Wooden Dowel

Used for aligning a countertop to their corresponding base cabinet and in some cases, for aligning two separate units or panels.

6. Varianta Screw

Commonly used for securing drawer runners to a carcass, these can also be used for Keku fixings.

7. Full Overlay Hinge

More information in the following section.

8. Half Overlay Hinge

More information in the following section.

9. Inset Hinge

More information in the following section.

10. Hinge Plate

Used for full & half overlay hinges, as well as inset hinges. Offering multiple position adjustments.

11. Undermount Runners

Soft-closing as standard, these are used for most all of the drawers. The length will depend on the available space within the cabinet.

12. Adjustable Leg

Mainly used to support the rear of a cabinet and typically beneath a Vertical Divider panel. These can also be included with kitchen carcasses.

13. Mini Leg

A minimalistic legs used on some cabinet designs where requested. These offer adjustment for leveling on uneven floors.

14. Unhanded Bracket

Used for smaller wall hanging cabinets. Attaches onto a wall plate with adjustment screws for leveling.

Essential Parts & Hardware

15. Anti-Tilt Bracket

Used on taller cabinets, or larger drawer units. Designed to prevent tipping and offer stabilisation.

16. Anti-Tilt Wall Plate

The wall plate that corresponds with the Anti-Tilt bracket.

17. Clamex P

A connecting biscuit typically used for aligning and fastening two parallel panels together, such as larger back panels. Fastened using a 4mm allen key.

18. Bisco

A simpler connecting biscuit used for aligning two parallel panels together, such as countertops.

19. 16mm Screw

The shortest wood screw with use in multiple purposes: hinges, drawer runner clips, hanging rail supports.

20. 30mm Screw

A commonly used wood screw for fastening countertops to their base unit, attaching side fillers or attaching Anti-Tilt Brackets to the cabinet.

21. 30mm Panhead Screw

A slightly different variation of screw commonly used for securing pre-finished back panels to edges of panels.

22. 40mm Screw

The longest wood screw used for securing top, bottom or fixed shelf panels to vertical dividers, or for securing adjustment leg based to a bottom panel. A thicker version of these are supplied for screwing into walls/wall plugs.

23. Back Panel Pins

A small pin used for securing thin back panels into the edges of panels.

24. 4mm Allen Key

Supplied with Clamex P fixings to allow for fastening.

25. Blind Corner Hinges

More information in the following section.

26. Wall Plug

Provided with Unhanded Bracket wall plates, or Anti-Tilt Bracket Plates. Please check what wall you have as these will not be suitable for every wall type.

Unusual Fittings

If you have any usual fittings not seen here and you're not sure how to use them, please contact us for support. We're always happy to provide help.

Hinge Guide (Types & When to Use Them)

Hinge Guide

Understanding which hinge goes where is one of the most common questions we receive.

Use this page to match your hinges to the correct door position.

Full Overlay Hinge

Use this when:

- The door covers the full side panel
- The door does not share that panel with another door

You'll typically find full overlay hinges on:

- End doors
- Single-door cupboards

How to recognise it:

- The hinge arm is straight



Half Overlay Hinge

Use this when:

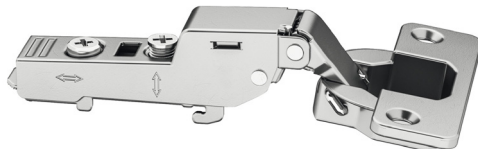
- Two doors share the same central panel
- Each door overlaps half the thickness of the panel

You'll typically find half overlay hinges on:

- Double, Triple or Quad cupboards that meet in the middle

How to recognise it:

- The hinge arm has a small knuckle



Inset Hinges

Use this when:

- The door sits inside the cabinet frame rather than in front of it

You'll typically find inset hinges on:

- Units designed with inset doors
- Units with the naming convention of 'M1'

How to recognise it:

- The hinge has a prominent knuckle on the arm



Blind Corner Hinge

Use this when:

- A door is attached to a face-frame
- A door is parallel with the framing it's connecting to

You'll typically find blind corner hinges on:

- Cabinet's with built-in face framing
- Some corner units

How to recognise it:

- Distinct "cranked" shape
- The hinge plate is pre-attached



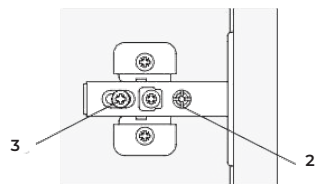
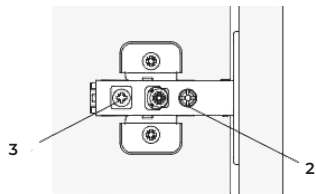
Adjusting Your Hinges

Adjusting Your Hinges

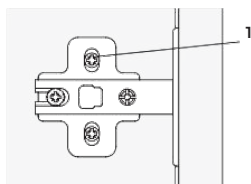
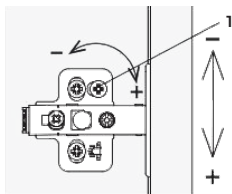
Once your doors are fitted, you may need to tweak the alignment.

Each hinge has 3 adjustments:

Hinge arm adjustment - side and depth



Mounting plate adjustment - height



1 - Height adjustment

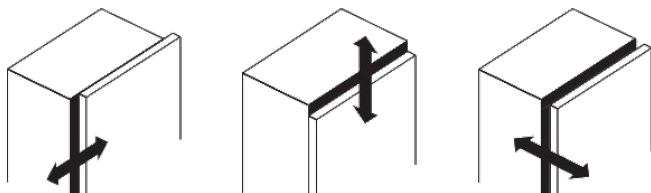
Via mounting plates using the 2-part plate: $\pm 2\text{mm}$

2 - Side adjustment

On hinge arm by rotating the screw: $+3\text{mm}/- 0.5\text{mm}$

3 - Depth adjustment

On hinge arm by rotating the cam adjuster screw or releasing the fixing screw for blind corner hinges. $+4\text{mm}/- 1\text{mm}$



How to Check Alignment

Look at the gaps

If one gap is larger than another, adjust the hinges to even it out. All gaps should be 3mm as standard.

Measure diagonally

If the cabinet is slightly twisted, the door gaps will show it. Ensure the cabinet is square to avoid this.

Factory settings

Side, height and depth adjustments will be set to a Zero position.

All other adjustments can be carried out independently of each other.

Before You Start Assembly

Before You Start Assembly

Your order will arrive in several boxes, and parts from different cabinets may be packed together.

Before building, take a few minutes to get organised - it will make the whole process much easier.

1. Unpack Everything

- Open all boxes carefully
- Lay the panels out on the floor or against a wall
- Group pieces by cabinet (use your exploded drawings to identify parts)
- Tick off each piece as you find it

2. Check Your Fitting Kit

Your fitting kit includes all the screws, cams, bolts, hinges, and runners needed for your order.

- Only the essential parts are included for your specific units
- If anything appears missing, just let us know and we'll send replacements

3. Identify Any Special Features

Before you begin assembly, check whether your cabinet has:

A Divider (Centre Vertical)

If yes, your assembly flow is slightly different — dividers must be fitted early.

A Face Frame

Face frames also affect assembly.

Left and right frames should usually be attached before the cabinet is fully built.

Fixed Shelves

Fixed shelves must be fitted during assembly, not afterwards.

4. The Best Order to Build Your Units

If your project includes multiple cabinets:

1. Start with the bottom-let unit
2. Build all lower cabinets first
3. Then build upper units
4. Wall units are usually last

Cabinet with Face Frames

Cabinets with Face Frames

Some cabinets include a face frame on the front to create a more traditional or decorative look. These units follow the same general assembly steps, but with one important difference:

Fit the face frames before finishing the cabinet assembly.

This makes it much easier to tighten the Rafx cams behind the frame and ensures everything lines up correctly.

How to Build Cabinet with Face Frames

1. Attach the Face Frames First

Fit the left, right and top face frame pieces to their corresponding panels before connecting the cabinet together.

Why?

Once the cabinet is assembled, the cams for the face frames can become difficult to reach and in some cases, they may obscure cams for other panels.

2. Fit Any Hinge Plates Before Assembly

If your face frame includes hinge plate holes, attach the hinge plate now. Doing this early avoids having to reach awkwardly inside the cabinet later.

3. Continue with Standard Assembly

After the frames and hinge plates are attached, proceed with the general method of assembly. Face frames don't make the assembly harder, they just require this one early step to save hassle later.



Cabinets with Centre Verticals

Vertical Dividers

Some larger cabinets include a centre vertical divider.

This divider helps support shelves and doors and strengthens the overall structure.

1. Start with the Inner Structure

Build the centre section first:

- Top panel
- Bottom panel
- Centre vertical(s)

This creates a rigid “spine” that the rest of the cabinet attaches to.

Note: This first stage can be heavy — having a second person helps.

2. Fix the Divider Correctly

MDF cabinets:

Each centre vertical will have a tenon (tongue) at the top and bottom that slides into a mortise (slot).

- One side of the tenon is flat
- The other side has a recessed cut-out

Unless shown otherwise on your plans, the **flat side always faces left**.

Coloured Cabinets:

- Coloured (pre-finished) panels will not have mortice & tenons and will only have Rafix cams. Each vertical dividing panel will have a label to help with orientation.
- Align and fasten the cams to lock the structure together.

3. 18mm Thick Back Panels

If your cabinet has 18mm thick back panels, it is crucial to fix the back panel before the vertical divider(s). The vertical dividers will obstruct access to the back panel fixings if they are installed first.

Once the top, bottom and dividers are connected, proceed with the standard method of assembly as shown later in this guide.

Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Standard Cabinet Assembly

This guide covers the most common type of cabinet we make.

Your exploded drawings show the exact parts for your unit, but the method below will be the same for most builds.

Step 1 - Prepare the Left Side Panel

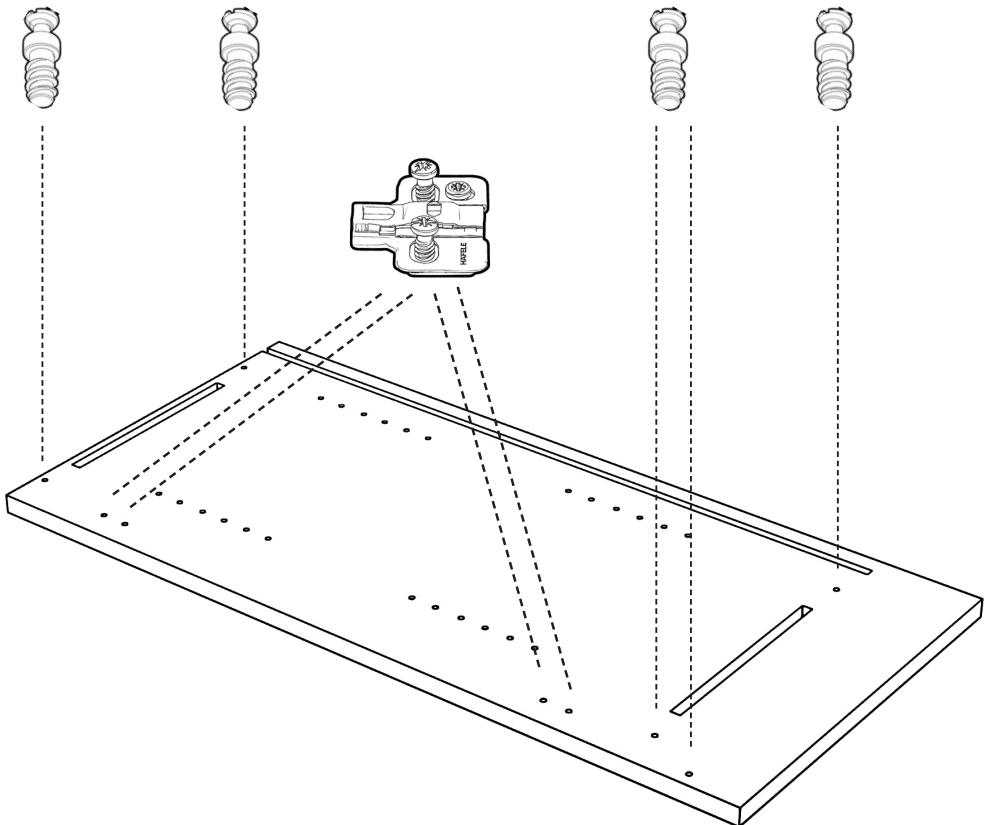
Lay the left side panel flat on your work surface with the inside face upwards.

Insert any cam screws into the 5mm holes where the corresponding panel's Rafx Cams will connect onto.

- Long columns of 5mm holes will be for shelf pins and do not require these screws.
- Paired 5mm holes along the front edge would be used for hinge plates.

Align and fasten the hinge plates if you have any.

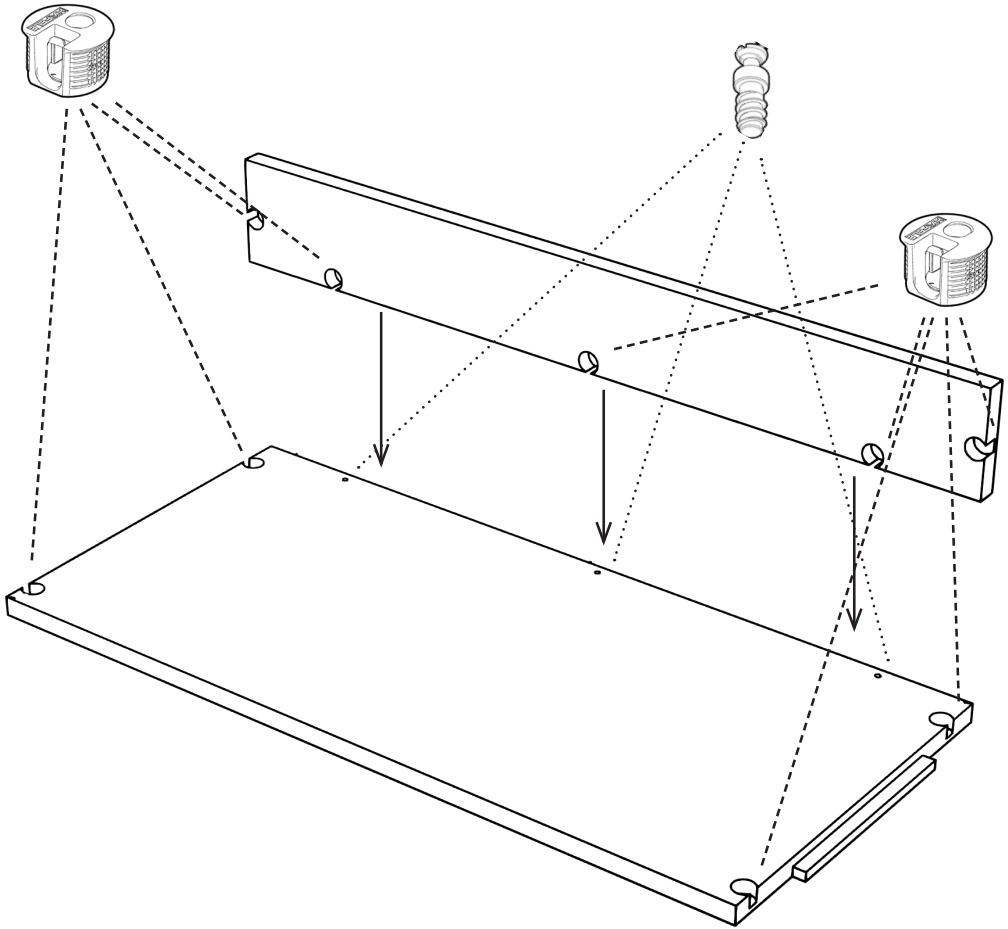
Tap any Rafx Cams into any 20mm diameter holes.



Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Step 2 - Attach the Plinth to the Bottom Panel

- Tap the Rafix Cams into all the 20mm holes on both panels
- Insert the cam screws into the bottom panel
- Align the plinth with the bottom panel ensuring the cam components are together
- Tighten the cams using a screwdriver



Follow the same procedure of tapping the Rafix Cams into the top panel.

Caution:

Be careful not to over-tighten the Rafix cams.

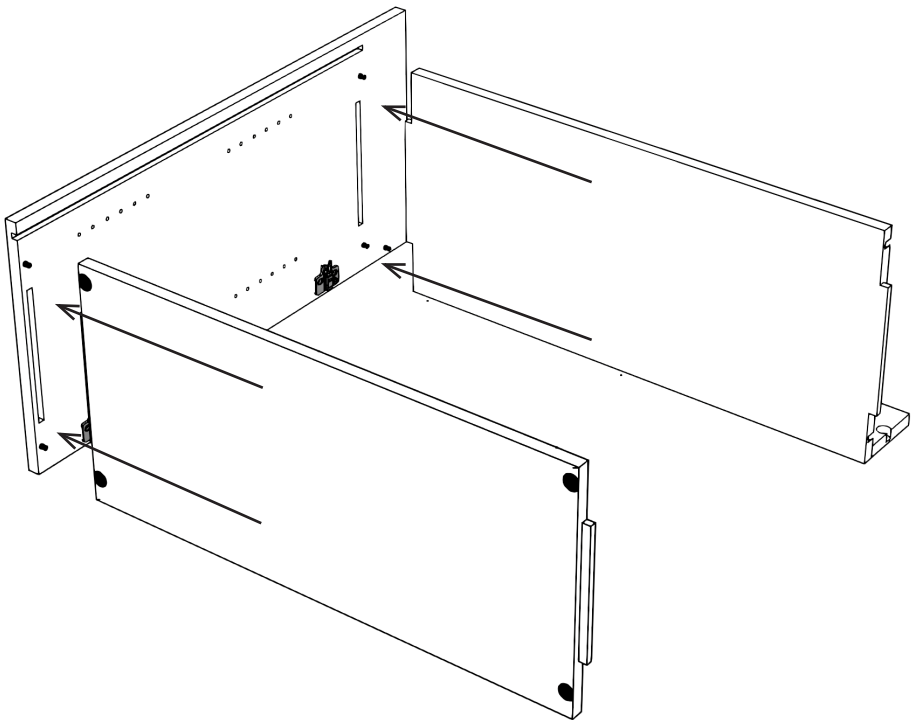
Over-tightening can damage the screw and make it difficult to disassemble.

Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Step 3 - Connect the Top & Bottom to the Left Side

- Stand the bottom & plinth panels (connected) on the floor with the front edges facing downwards
- Position the left side panel with the cam screws and locks aligned
- Fasten the cams until tight
- Continue to do the same with the top panel

You should now have the top, bottom, plinth and left side panels securely connected.



Repeat the same process with the right side panel until you have both sides, top and bottom all fastened together.

Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Step 4 - Fit the Back Panel

- With the cabinet still face down on the floor, prepare some room to slide the back panel into the grooves
- Slide the back panel into the grooves until the top of the back panel is flush with the top of the carcass

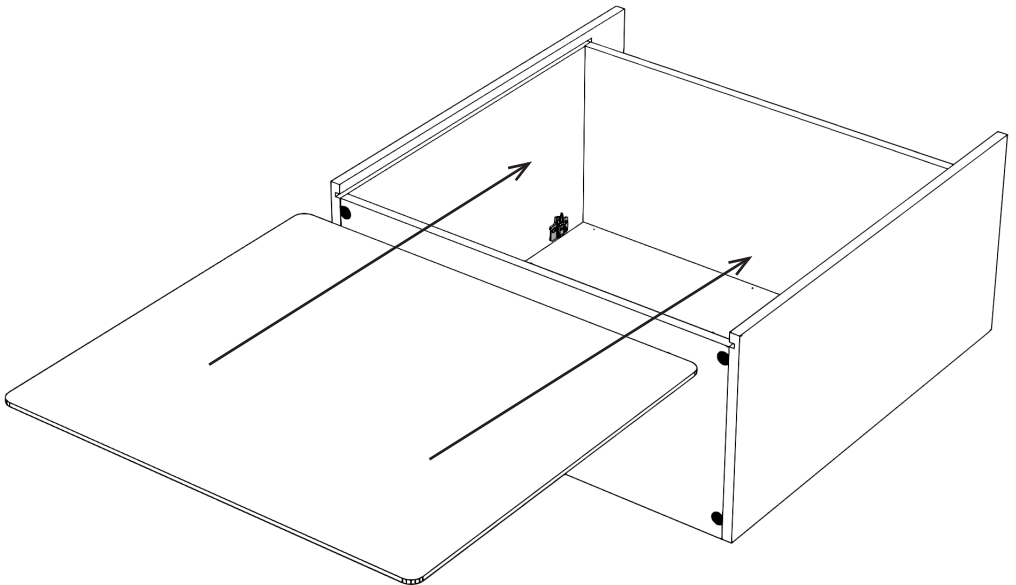
Square Your Cabinet

Measure diagonally from corner to corner to ensure the cabinet is square before fixing the back panel, which locks its position:

- Top left → bottom right
- Top right → bottom left

Adjust the cabinet gently until both measurements match — this ensures the cabinet sits perfectly square.

- Fix the back panel using the provided screws and pins

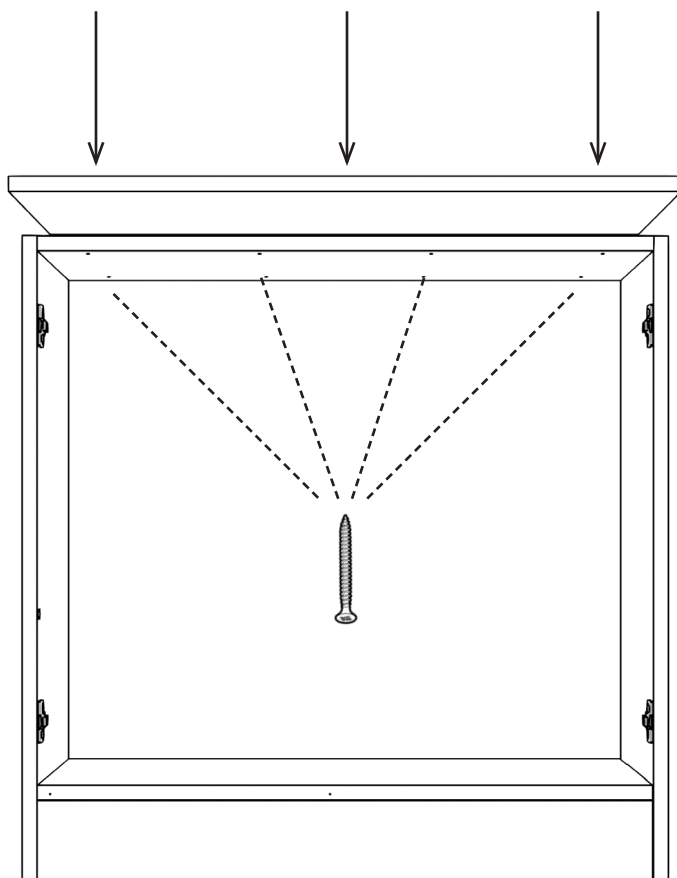


Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Step 5 - Fit the Countertop (if supplied)

- Stand the cabinet upright
- Insert the 5mm wooden dowels into the two holes on top
- Position the countertop onto the dowels for perfect alignment
- Fix using 30mm screws through the pre-drilled holes within the unit

If your cabinet is designed to be built into an alcove, wooden dowels will not be included to allow for a more accurate positioning within the space.



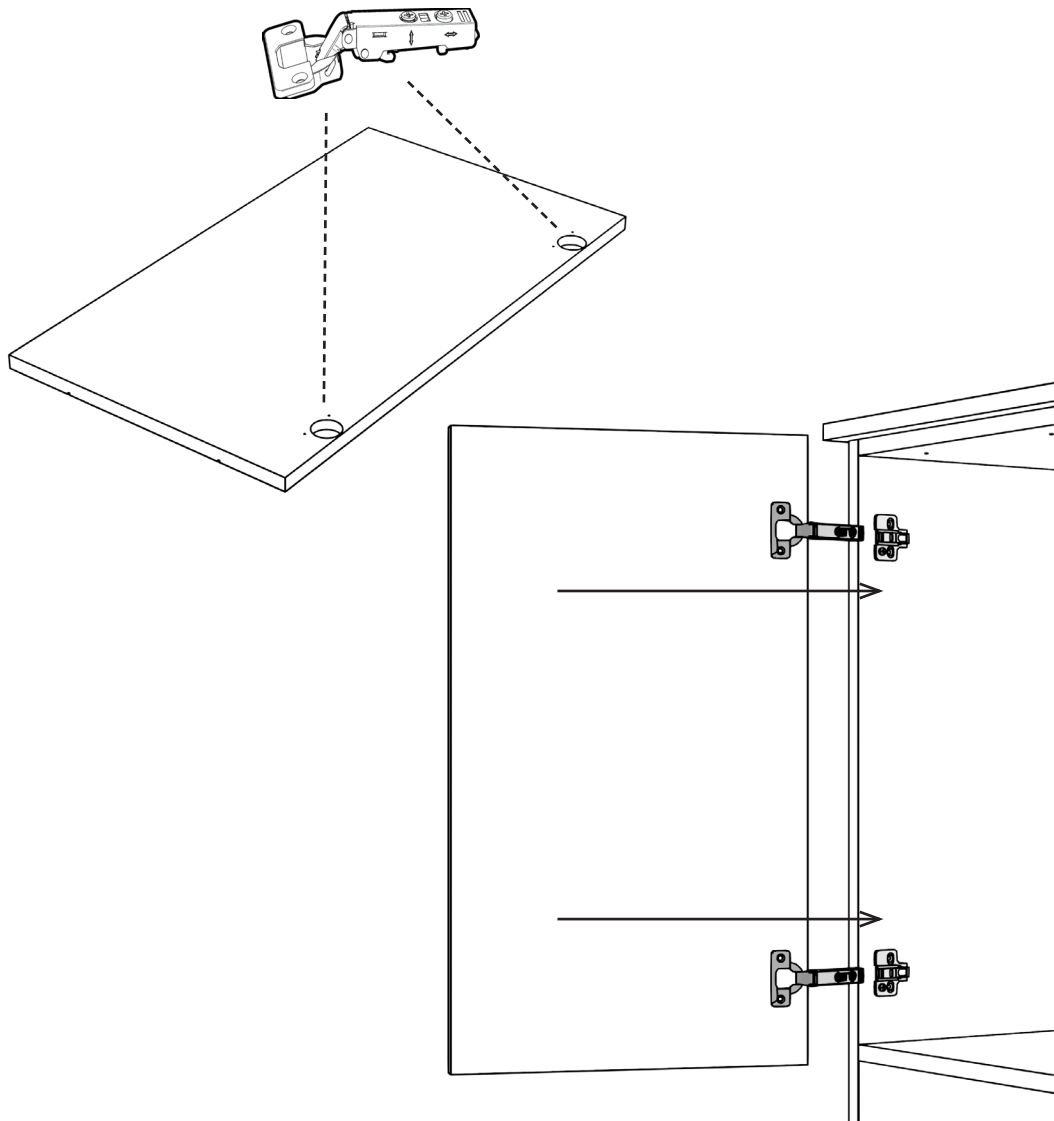
Check the tightness

Sometimes you may need to loosen a screw and refasten to close any gaps between the carcass and the countertop.

Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Step 6 - Fit Hinges and Doors

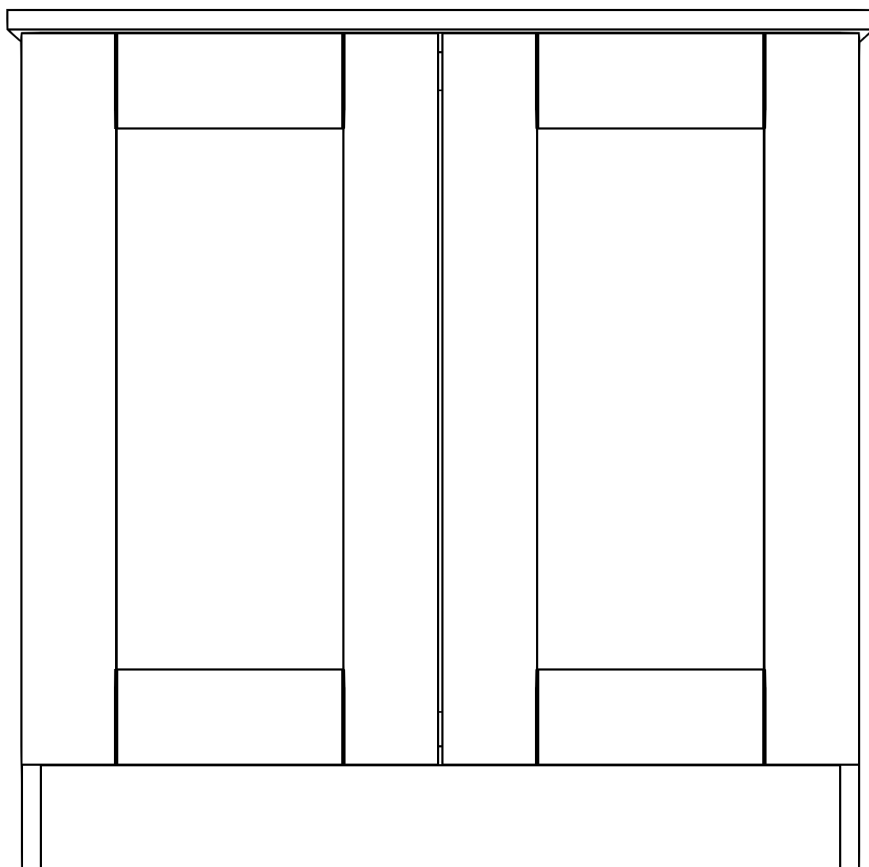
- Attach the hinges to the door(s) using the 16mm screws
- Clip the doors onto the plates (or slide on if blind corner hinges)
- Use the adjustment screws to align gaps evenly (see hinge section)



Standard Cabinet Assembly (Step-by-Step)

Your Cabinet Is Now Complete!

Any shelves can now be placed in the cabinet.



Check the tightness

Sometimes you may need to loosen a screw and refasten to close any gaps between the carcass and the countertop.

Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Our drawers use high-quality undermount runners that clip on and off easily.
All drawers assemble using the same steps — only the height of the sides or runners may differ.

Before You Begin

Each drawer comes with:

- a front
- a back
- two sides
- a bottom
- 2x runners (left & right)
- 2x clip-on corner pieces (fitted under the drawer)

Drawer Identification:

Not all drawers will be identical. It is important to use the appropriate drawer parts for each drawer.
On the drawer part's label, the panel name will follow with an identification number which can be identified as the example's below:

... [1]_1
... [1]_2

... [1]_1	... [2]_1
... [1]_2	... [2]_2

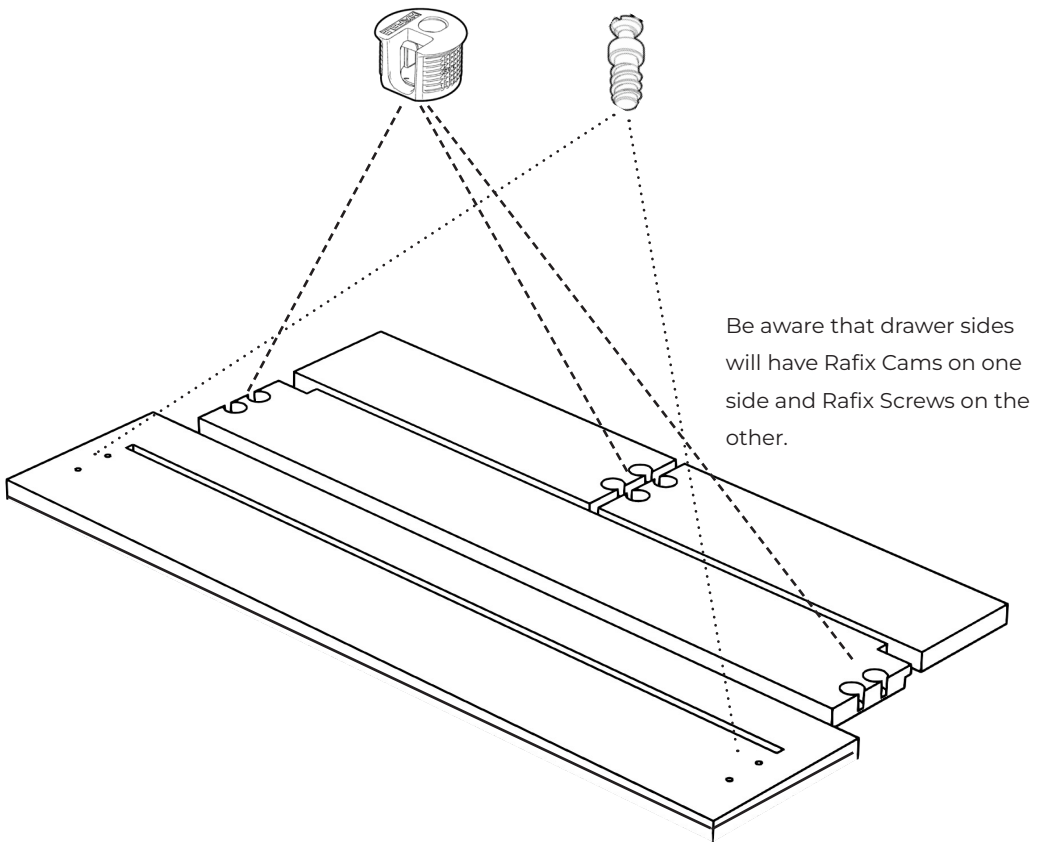
Stay organised

Cabinets can have as many as 20 drawers. To save time and clutter, separate the drawer part types (left sides, right sides, etc.) and insert the fittings in bulk.

Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 1 - Prepare the Drawer Parts

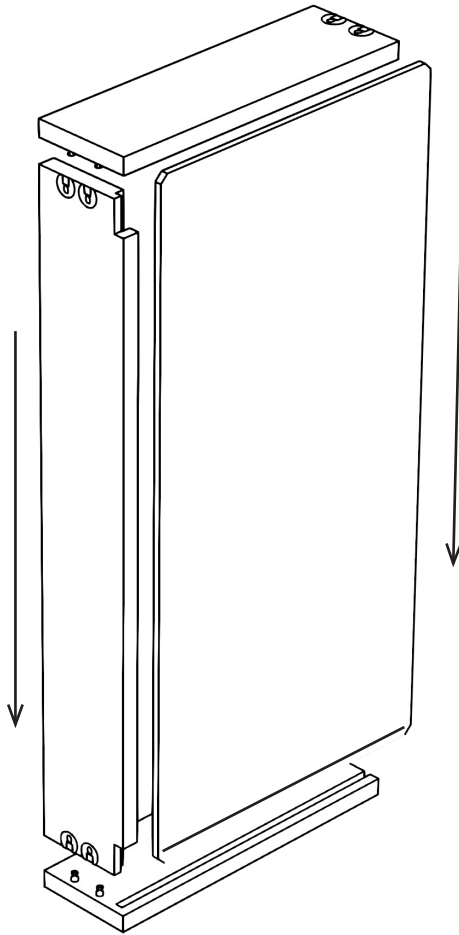
- Insert the Rafix Cams into all the 20mm holes for each drawer part
- Insert the Rafix Screws into all the corresponding 5mm holes on the drawer sides and front



Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 2 - Build the Drawer Box

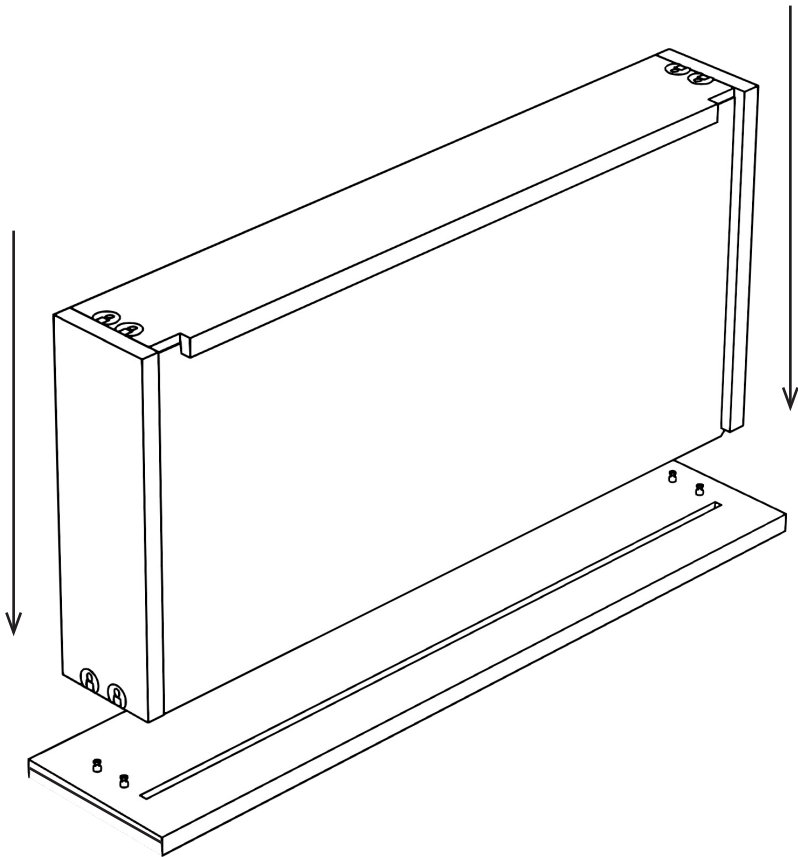
- Lay the drawer side flat on the floor with the groove upwards
- Align the drawer back and fasten the cams
- Slide the drawer bottom into the grooves
- Align the other drawer side and fasten the cams



Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 2 - Build the Drawer Box (continued)

- Lay the drawer front flat with the groove upwards
- Flip the drawer box onto the drawer front, slotting the bottom into the groove
- Fasten the cams until tight

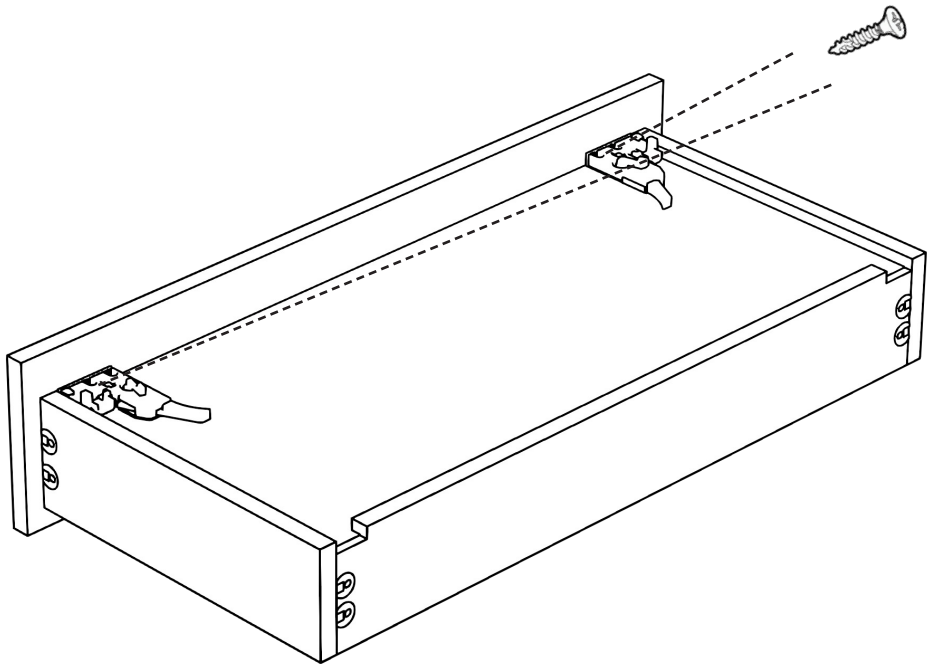


Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 3 - Fit the Corner Clips

These clips allow the drawer to connect to the runners

- Position the clips underneath the front corners of the drawer
- Fix them using the short 16mm screws
- There will be pre-drilled holes on the drawer front for easy alignment



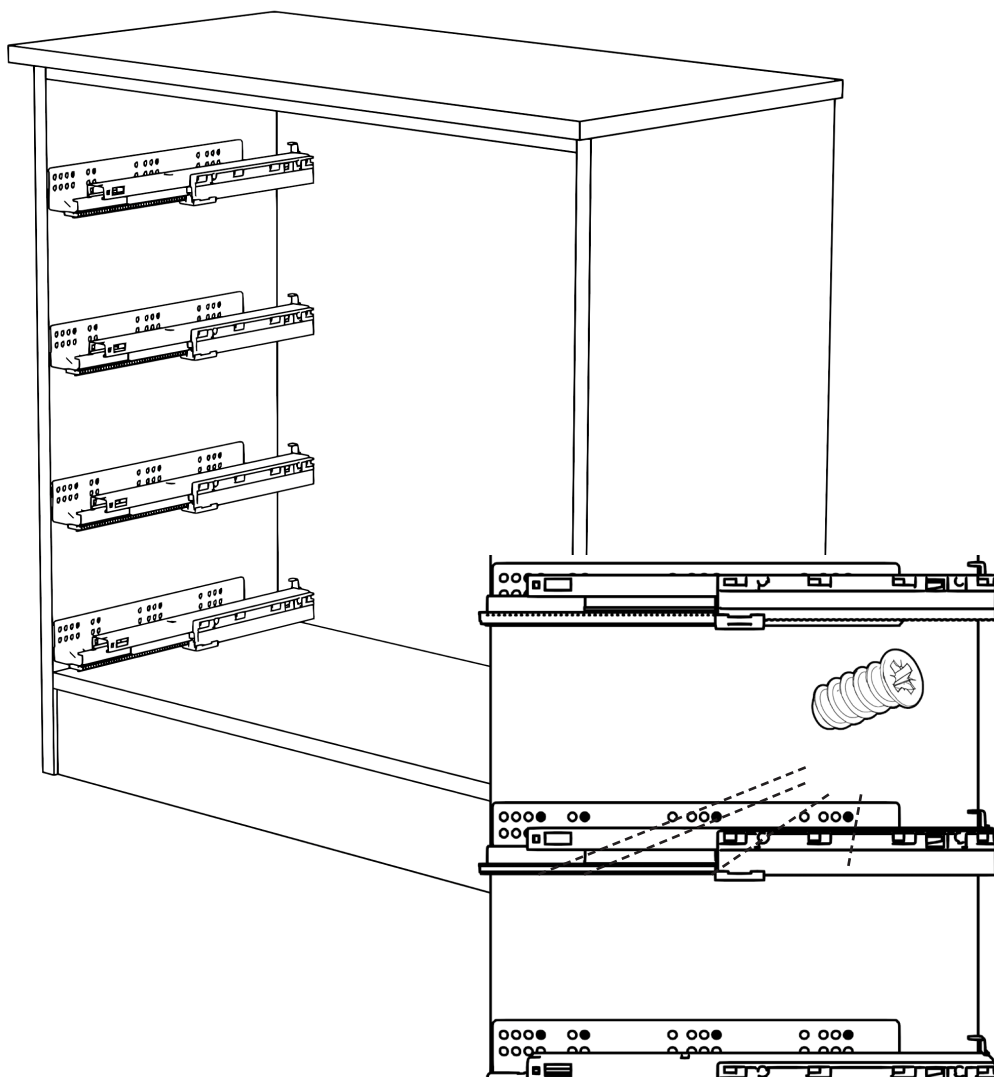
Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 4 - Install the Runners in the Cabinet

Inside your cabinet:

- Line up each drawer runner with the pre-drilled holes on the cabinet sides
- Fix them using the supplied Varianta screws
- Make sure the runners are level and fully pushed back

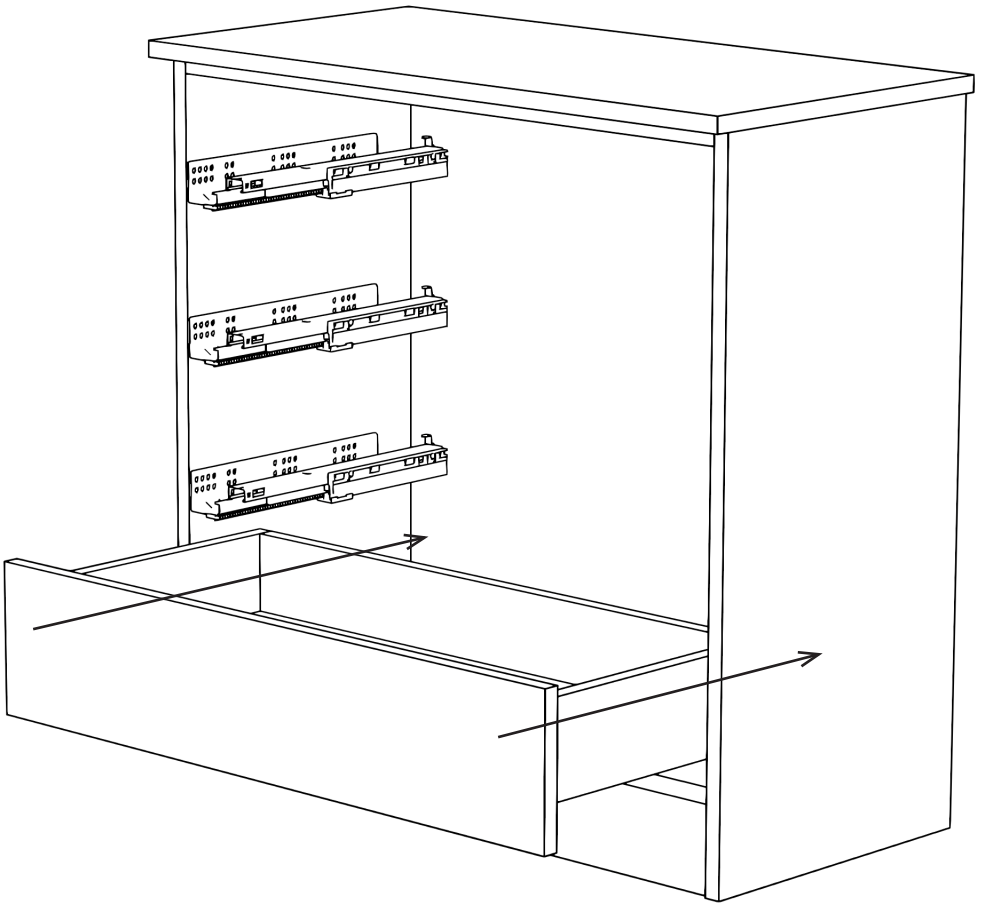
Left and right runners will have a marking on the actual runner to identify which is which.



Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 5 - Fit the Drawer

- Slide the drawer onto the runners and push firmly until both clips “click” into place.
If one side clicks and the other doesn’t, remove the drawer and try again — don’t force it.



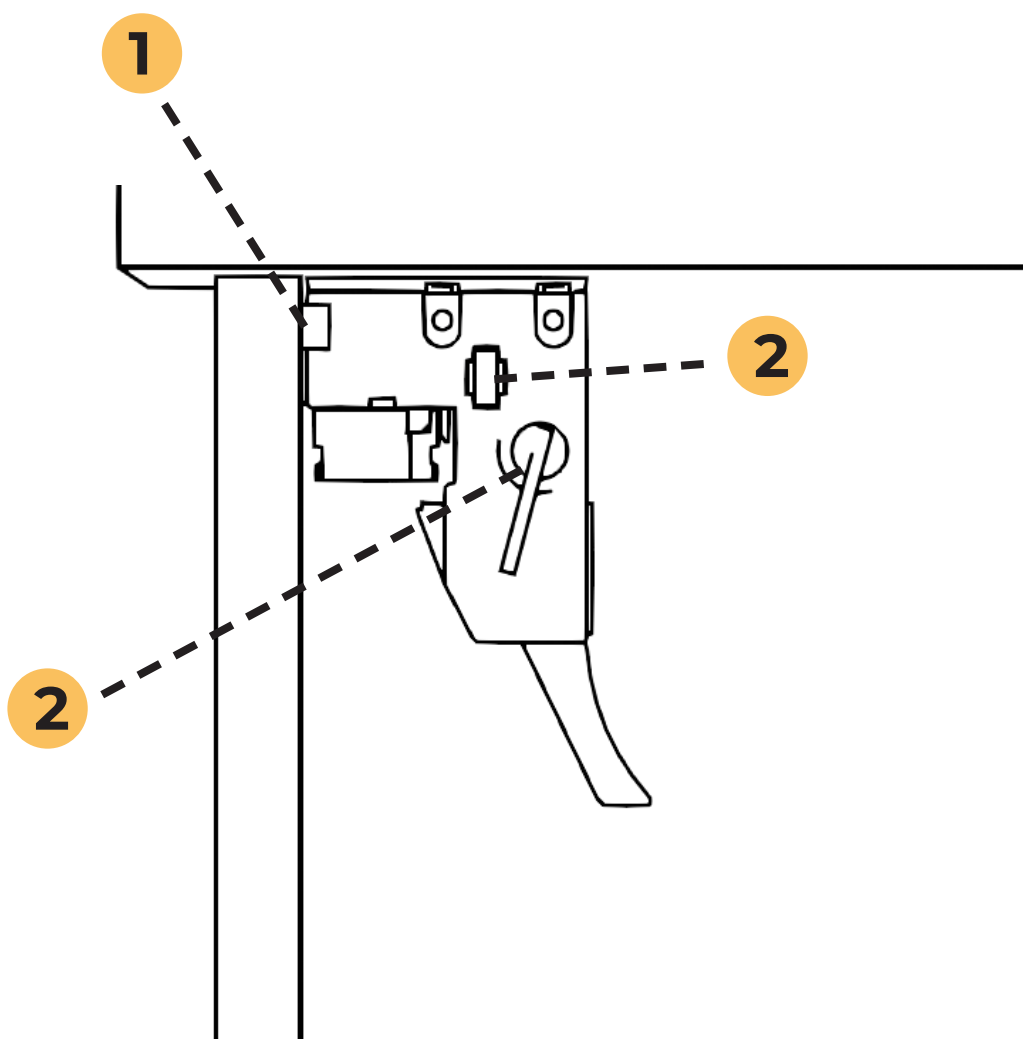
Drawer Assembly & Fitting

Step 6 - Adjust Your Drawer

Under each drawer are three small adjustments built into the clips:

1. Up/Down: Aligns the height of the drawer
2. Left/Right: Adjusts the gap between drawers
3. In/Out: Sets how far the drawer front sits against the cabinet

These allow you to get perfectly even lines across multiple drawers.



Upper Unit & Dresser Tops

Upper units are lighter than base units but require a slightly different approach during assembly and installation. Whether you're fitting a dresser top, a wall cabinet, or a multi-section upper storage unit, the steps below will help you build and position it safely.

Step 1 - Build the Unit on the Floor First

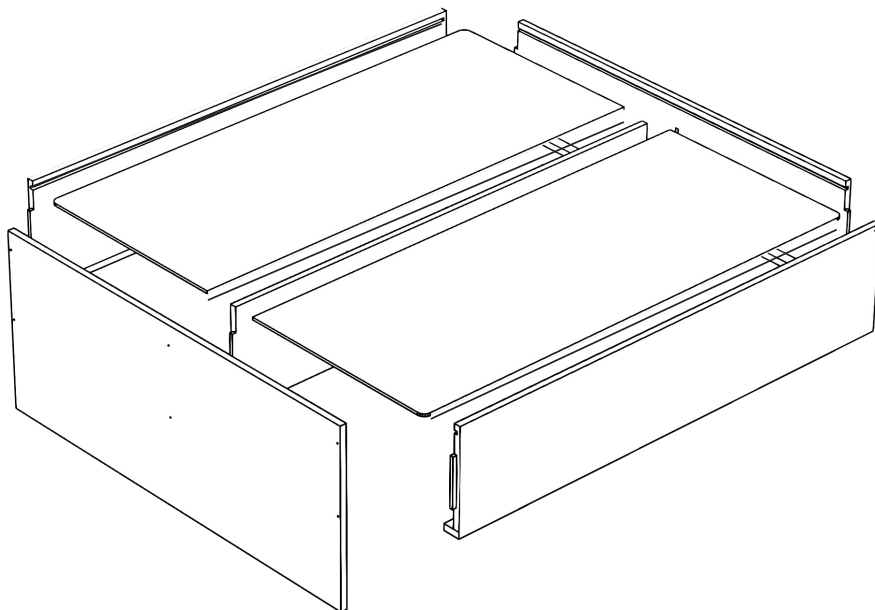
As with base unit:

- Assemble the upper unit lying flat
- The order of assembly is slightly different to base units as the bottom is attached last
- Do not attempt to assemble the unit while holding it against a wall

This keeps everything square and makes installation easier.

Method of Assembly

1. Insert all Rafx Screws and locks into the appropriate holes on the sides, top, bottom, vertical dividers (if included) and fixed shelves (if included)
2. Pre-attach any face frames if your design has them
3. Start with the top panel, front edge facing down on the floor
4. Connect the vertical divider(s) to the top if your design has them
5. Connect the sides to the top panel
6. Slide the back panel into the groove
7. Align and fix the bottom panel to the structure using the 40mm screws



Upper Unit & Dresser Tops

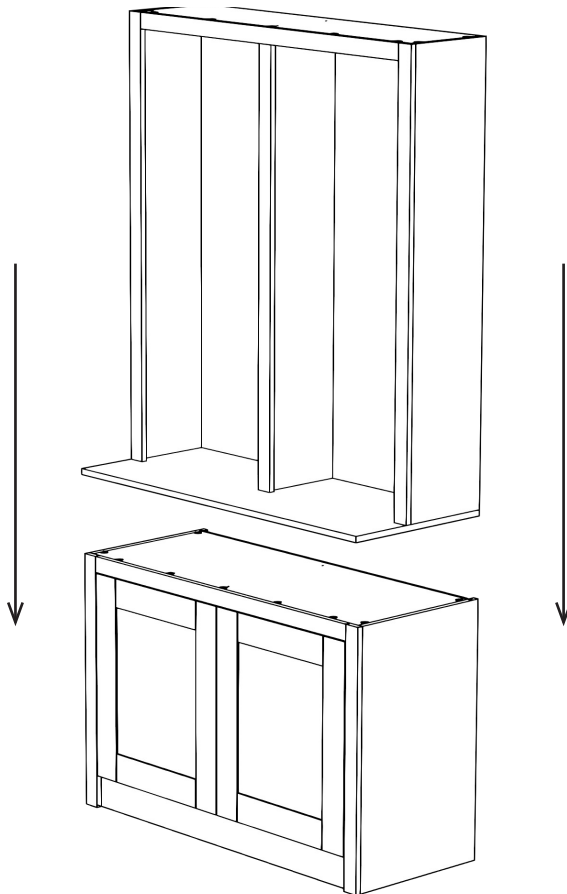
Step 2 - If the Upper Unit Sits on a Base Unit

For dresser-style combinations:

- With the base units in place, lift the upper unit on top
- If you have multiple upper units, start with either the far left or right depending on what's easier in the space
- Multiple upper units will have biscuits on the bottoms/countertop edges to help with alignment

Caution:

Upper Units can be heavy and may need 2 people to help lift it into place.



Upper Unit & Dresser Tops

Step 3 - Securing the Upper Unit

1. Ensure the positioning is aligned with the base unit
2. Use 40mm screws to fix the upper unit to the base unit from within the base unit

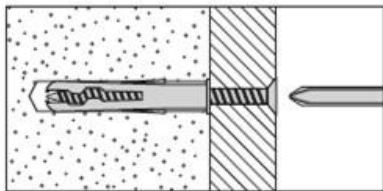
Larger dresser may have a 'wall bar' panel fixed to the top rear of the upper unit. These are to allow for screwing directly through the back panel, through the wall bar and into the wall to keep everything secure.

Wall Fixings Guide

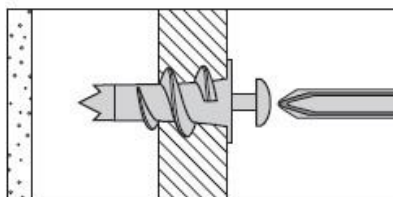
Different walls will require different wall fixings to ensure a safe and rigid mounting.

Wall fixings are not supplied and should be purchased based on the type of wall you'll be securing into.

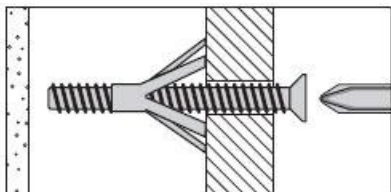
General purpose wall plug



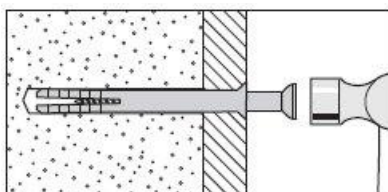
Plasterboard wall plug



Cavity fixing wall plug



Hammer fixing wall plug



If you have studs behind your wall to screw into, use your screw 40mm or 50mm screws directly into these.

A stud finder can be used to locate any studs you have behind your wall.

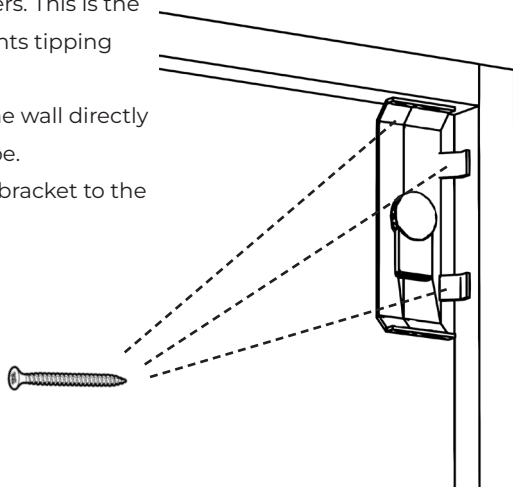
Anti-Tilt Brackets

Anti-tilt brackets are supplied for some taller cabinets or multiple drawer units to prevent any tipping.

Even if your unit feels stable when empty, we strongly recommend installing the anti-tilt brackets wherever they are supplied.

Where Anti-Tilt Brackets Are Fitted

- Brackets will be positioned behind the cabinets back panel, at the top corners. This is the strongest fixing point and prevents tipping instantly.
- Bracket plates are attached to the wall directly behind where the brackets will be.
- Use 30mm screws to attach the bracket to the rear of the cabinet.

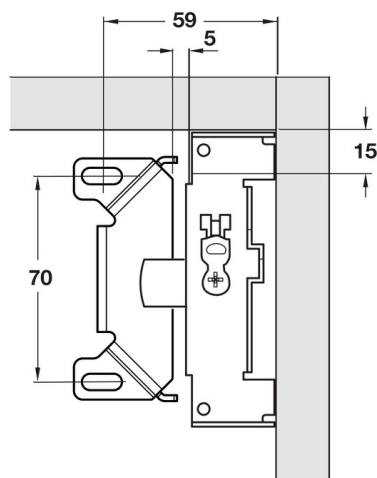


Scan for Video Tutorial



Attaching the Bracket Plate to the Wall

- Stand the cabinet in its final position and lightly mark on your wall the top corners of the cabinet. Be sure to mark it lightly enough that it removed afterwards.
- Move the cabinet out of the way and use a tape measure or ruler to measure and mark the plates screw holes by relation to the diagram.
- Check to see which wall fixings you'll need as seen in the information on the previous page.
- Fix the plates to the wall.



The cabinet can now be repositioned and the brackets locked onto the plates.

Need Help?

We're here to make sure your assembly goes smoothly.

If you get stuck at any stage, or something doesn't look quite right, just get in touch — we're always happy to help.

Contact Us

Email: office@thecabinetshop.co.uk

Phone: 0345 459 0540

(Monday - Thursday, 9am - 4pm)

(Friday, 10am - 2pm)

Send Us Photos

If you're unsure about a part, layout, or fitting step, the quickest way for us to help is by sending a photo.

Scan the QR code below to upload pictures directly from your phone.

We're Here to Help

No question is too small — and it's always better to ask than to undo work later.

We want your cabinetry to look perfect, and we'll support you from start to finish.

Scan the QR code to send us a photo and ask
for any help.

